

CONDITIONALS

Type zero



ZERO CONDITIONAL (Type 0)

- We use the **zero conditional** to talk about:
 - ✓ general truths
 - ✓ scientific facts
 - ✓ things that are always true
 - ✓ habits or routines
- It means: “Whenever this happens, that always happens.”



- **Formula:** If + Subject + Verb (present), Subject + Verb (present)
- **General truths:**
 - If you heat ice, it melts.
 - If you mix red and blue, you get purple.
- **Science facts:**
 - If water reaches 100°C, it boils.
 - If you drop an object, it falls to the ground.
- **Habits / routines:**
 - If I drink coffee at night, I don't sleep well.
 - If she eats too much sugar, she feels sick.
- **Cause and effect:**
 - If you press this button, the machine starts.
 - If you don't water plants, they die.



Present Simple + Present Simple

- *Most common form*
- **Structure: If + Present Simple, Present Simple**
 - **If** the weather is fine, we eat outside.
 - **If** I feel tired, I go to bed early.
 - Anvar doesn't sleep well, **if** he drinks coffee.
- ✓ *Meaning: every time this happens → this result happens*



Present Continuous + Present Simple

- **Used** *when situation is happening NOW / temporarily*
- **Structure:** **If + Present Continuous, Present Simple**
 - If the kids are playing outside, I don't interrupt them.
 - If she is working late, she usually skips dinner.
 - If I am studying hard, I don't use my phone.
- ✓ Meaning: "at this moment / this period"



Present Continuous + Present Continuous

- Both *actions are temporary ongoing situations*
- Structure: **If + Present Continuous, Present Continuous**
 - If the economy is growing fast, it is becoming unstable.
 - If I am feeling stressed, I am eating less.
 - If she is studying, she is avoiding social media.
- ✓ Meaning: *both actions are happening at the same time*



Past Simple + Past Simple

- *We use them for: repeated actions, habits, situations that always happened in the past*
- **Structure: If + Past Simple, Past Simple**
 - **If** my father had a day off, we went to visit grandparents.
 - **If** it rained, we stayed at home.
 - **If** I was hungry, I ate snacks.
- ✓ *Meaning: every time in the past → same result*



Past Simple + Past Continuous

- *Repeated and ongoing action in the past*
- **Structure: If + Past Simple, Past Continuous**
 - Kevin always came in **if** he was passing our house.
 - **If** I was walking to school, I listened to music.
 - **If** she was cooking, I helped her.
- ✓ *Meaning: one action happens during another ongoing action*



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Rules of Zero Conditional

- **1. NOT imaginary** - Real conditionals are NOT “fantasy”:

✗ If I were rich, I would... (this is unreal conditional)

✓ If I have money, I spend it. (real)

- **2. Tense depends on time**

- Present → present forms

- Past → past forms

- **3. Often = repeated behavior**

- Words like: **always | usually | every time | often**

- signal **REAL** conditional



Negative/Question

- **Negative form**

- Plants die **if** you don't water them.
- **If** he doesn't study, he fails exams.
- I feel tired **if** I don't eat breakfast.

- **Question form** - We usually use the result clause as a question:

- What happens **if** you heat water?
- **If** you press this button, what happens?
- Does ice melt **if** you heat it?



Summary

Type	Structure
Present real	If + present, present
Continuous real	If + continuous, present/continuous
Past real	If + past, past

